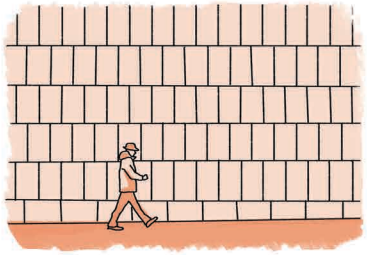
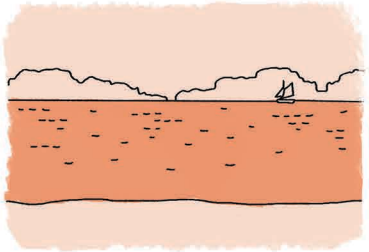
LINES

Lines serve to create photographic composition in two ways. They add repetition, tension, or emotion to scenes. They lead the viewer's eye through the photograph, keeping their attention focused on the main subject.

Horizontal

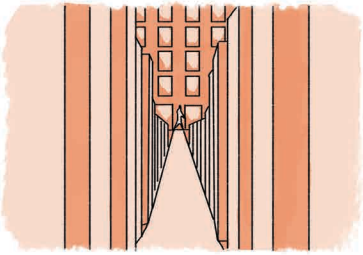


Horizontal lines express stability. Balance comes from their association with the ever present horizon.

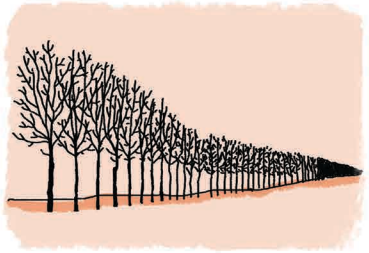


Distance and breadth are also strong here. Use when capturing a scene to separate subjects or contrasting areas.

Vertical

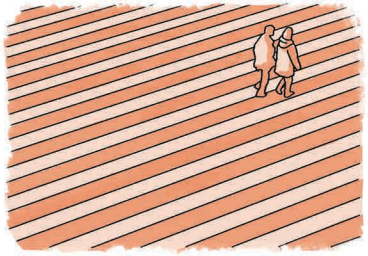


Vertical lines appear in objects that either give in to gravity or try to escape it. They represent strength.



They're best used for rock formations, buildings or forests. This is a great area to show repetition through numbers.

Diagonal



Diagonal lines add a sense of action, or add a dynamic mood to a scene.

Jagged and Irregular

These lines do not follow any rules, so they add a sense of tension.

LEADING LINES

Leading lines are a composition technique where the viewer's attention is drawn to lines that lead to the image's main subject.

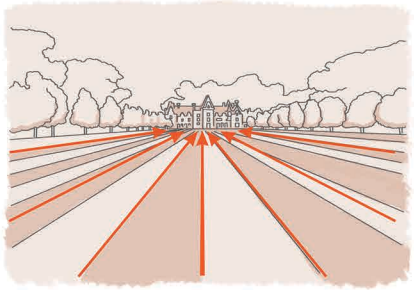
What Can You Use

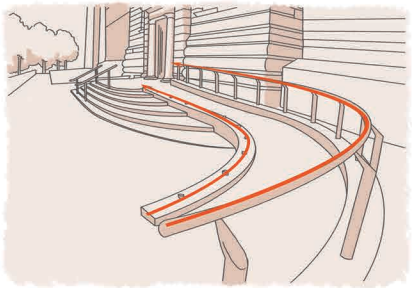
Roads

Rails

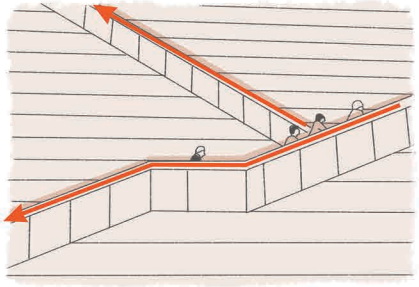
Shadows

How to Use Leading Lines





Break the Rule



Out of Frame

Leading lines that pull your eyes in multiple directions create dynamic tension. The competing directions for your eyes to follow make it hard to know where to look.